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Reading Comprehension Strategies

A parent-friendly guide to the reading strategies we use in class — great for supporting home reading.

These are the six comprehension strategies we practice regularly in class. Using even one or two of these during home reading time can make a big difference in how much your child understands and remembers.

Predicting

Before reading, guess what might happen based on the cover, title, or pictures.

Try asking: "What do you think this book will be about?"

Questioning

Ask questions while reading — about characters, events, or words that are confusing.

Try asking: "Why do you think the character did that?"

Visualizing

Picture the story in your mind like a movie as you read.

Try asking: "What do you imagine this place looks like?"

Making Connections

Connect the story to your own life, another book, or the world.

Try asking: "Does this remind you of anything that happened to you?"

Summarizing

Retell the main events in a few sentences, in order.

Try asking: "Can you tell me what happened in just 3 sentences?"

Inferring

Use clues in the text plus what you already know to figure out things the author doesn't say directly.

Try asking: "What do you think is really going on here?"

A Simple Routine

- Before reading: make a prediction together.
- During reading: pause once or twice to ask a question.

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- After reading: ask for a short summary in your child's own words.